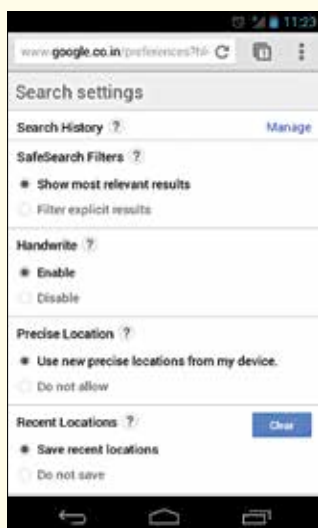




Handwritten searches FTW

Search your history

Google Search also lets you access the history of your search activity on the search engine. Think of it as Google's very own History tab, similar to the one found in most web browsers these days. And you also have the ability to purge your search activity selectively or completely restrict and protect your online privacy. It's a great way to mine your own data and recollect and revisit what you were trying to search in the past.

As a rule, Google only records your search activity if and when you're logged into a Google account through a web browser. To see your Google Search history, visit google.com/history to see the complete list of keywords that you searched through Google starting from today and going backwards



Analyze your Google account's search history

in time. Google also readily showcases an hourly, daily and monthly search activity related graph for your account – it's a great way to analyze your Google Search habits. However, if you're worried about the implications of Google's search history and don't want your keywords recorded, you can easily turn the feature off or delete all past search history through the Settings tab visible under the now familiar Gears tab on the top right of the page.

Find related pages

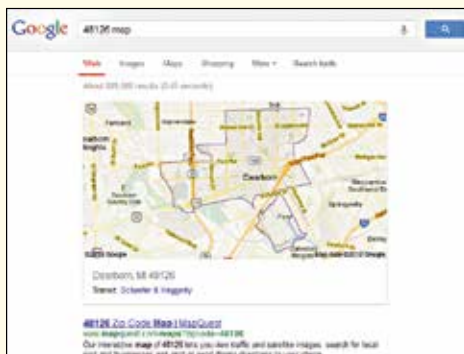
How cool would it be for you to encounter websites similar to a topic that you're interested in? We know there are blogging services and tools available to do this, but their scope doesn't really encapsulate the true expanse of the World Wide Web. Google Search makes discovering websites of a particular topic a lot easier than you'd think. It makes use of a Google operator called "related".

Just copy the URL of a website you liked, visit Google's home page. Type in "related:" and the URL without any space in between and hit [Enter]. The resulting search page will list out websites that Google thinks are related to the topic you're interested in. Give it a try.

Search for an address

Google lets you enter pincode numbers to find their exact location. This is because Google understands pincodes as more than a set of numbers and their unique function. For instance, if you type in just "560027" in Google's search page, it will return search results that will have at least one link referring to the exact location of the area.

Furthermore, if you append a pincode with the word "map", Google will try and give you the exact location of the place on Google Maps. So say we typed in "560027 map", the search results will be even more pre-



Searching for an address was never this easy

cise for Indian addresses, while for American zip code searches, Google will return a small map view at the top of the page with the exact area covered under the zip code.

ALTERNATIVES TO GOOGLE READER

Google did another round of 'spring cleaning' last month, and one of the services to get the axe was our much loved Google Reader. Sad news indeed, but it's not the end of the world. There exist a number of alternative ways to consume RSS feeds, and Google Reader's untimely demise has shifted the focus to these alternatives, for whom this is a golden opportunity to fill the void that Reader will leave behind.

Cross-platform Alternatives (Web + Mobile App / Desktop + Mobile)

Feedly

One of the first services to respond to the news of Reader's imminent shutdown was the popular magazine-style reader Feedly. One of the more comprehensive alternatives, Feedly has browser extensions for Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox and Apple's Safari, along with free apps for iOS, Android and the Kindle Fire. It uses a ranking algorithm to push the most popular or relevant stories to the top, and lets you switch between different layouts, from a traditional list-based interface (similar to Reader) to one with large-tiles, similar to a magazine. While it currently uses Google Reader as a backend, Feedly has stated that it's working on a project called Normandy which will clone the Reader API, enabling it to "seamlessly transition to the Normandy back end" when Reader shuts down. Check it out here: <http://feedly.com>

Reeder (Mac / iOS)

Reeder is a wonderful example of the great design and pol-



Feedly lets you browse your feeds in a magazine format